

Inkscape Setup Cards Guide

Summary

This is a brief doc outlining how to create a wargame/consim setup chart in [Inkscape](#) using counters from [Vassal](#).

This is not a 'how to use Inkscape'. If you need more detailed instructions to do use Inkscape, stop reading this guide now, it will not help you. Go and work through their tutorial. (Inkscape is not simple, but can do simple things well). If you find something in the guide that you don't understand, Google is your friend. If you cannot find help, add a comment to ask a question, but this is **not** a guide to Inkscape basics.

Why Inkscape?

Inkscape is a *vector* editor, it represents graphics mathematically rather than with pixels. It saves info in internet standard SVG language (like HTML), rather than as pictures.

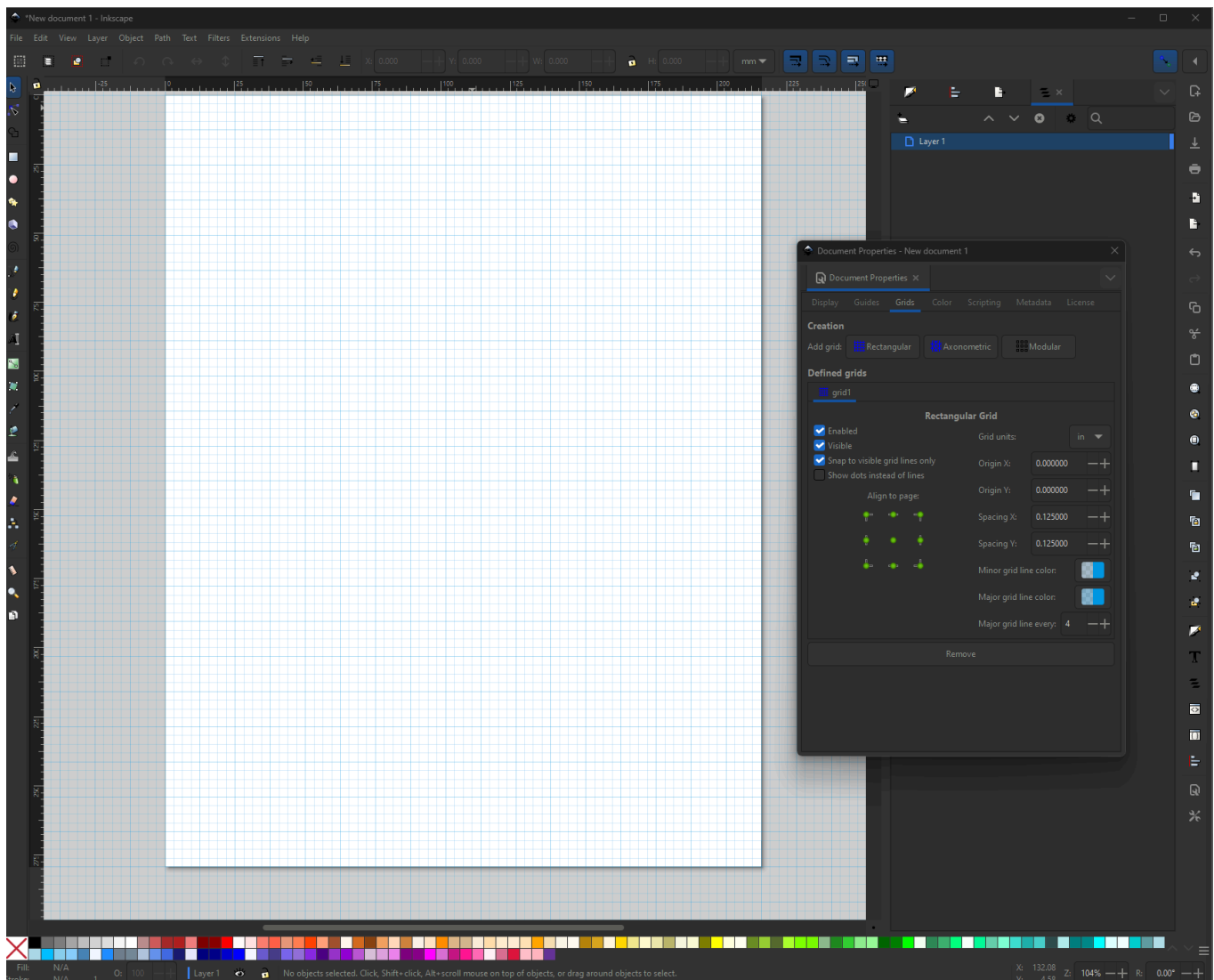
Although much of the content is images, Inkscape is very good at boxes and alignment, and I prefer to use Inkscape (or Adobe Illustrator) over Gimp (or Photoshop). Inkscape also has an amazing price (free) and runs on PC, Mac and Linux. This guide is based on PC, I have macs and linux but will not be doing different guides for those, you will have to work out the (minor) differences. I'm sure that will be fine if you use Linux, maybe not so much if you are a mac user ;-)

Create a Blank Document

Create a new inkscape document.

I recommend an 8 1/2 x 11" US letter page for worldwide users, and a 1/4" grid via

File/Document Properties

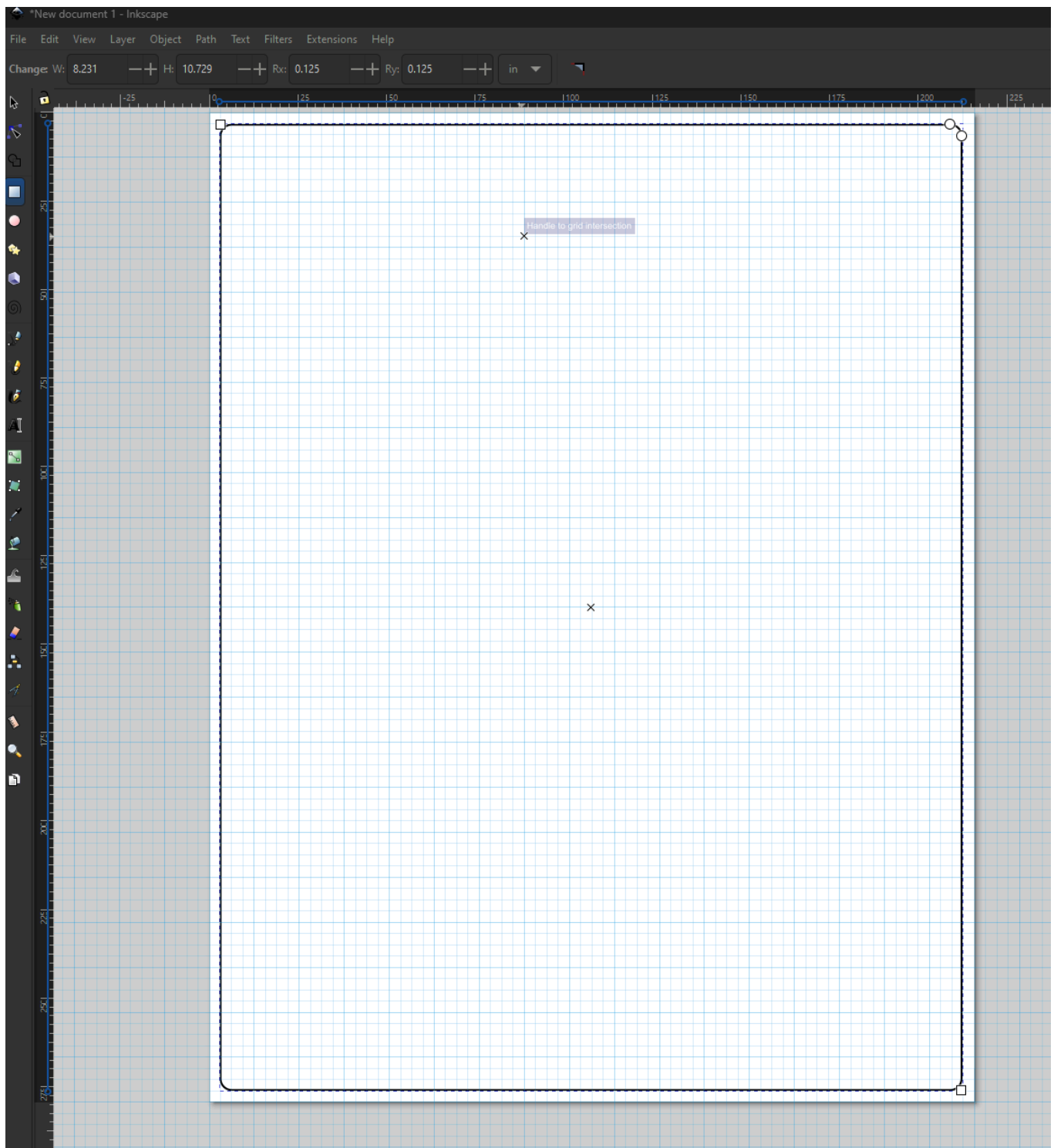


The grid is your friend; make sure Snapping is on in the top right hand corner

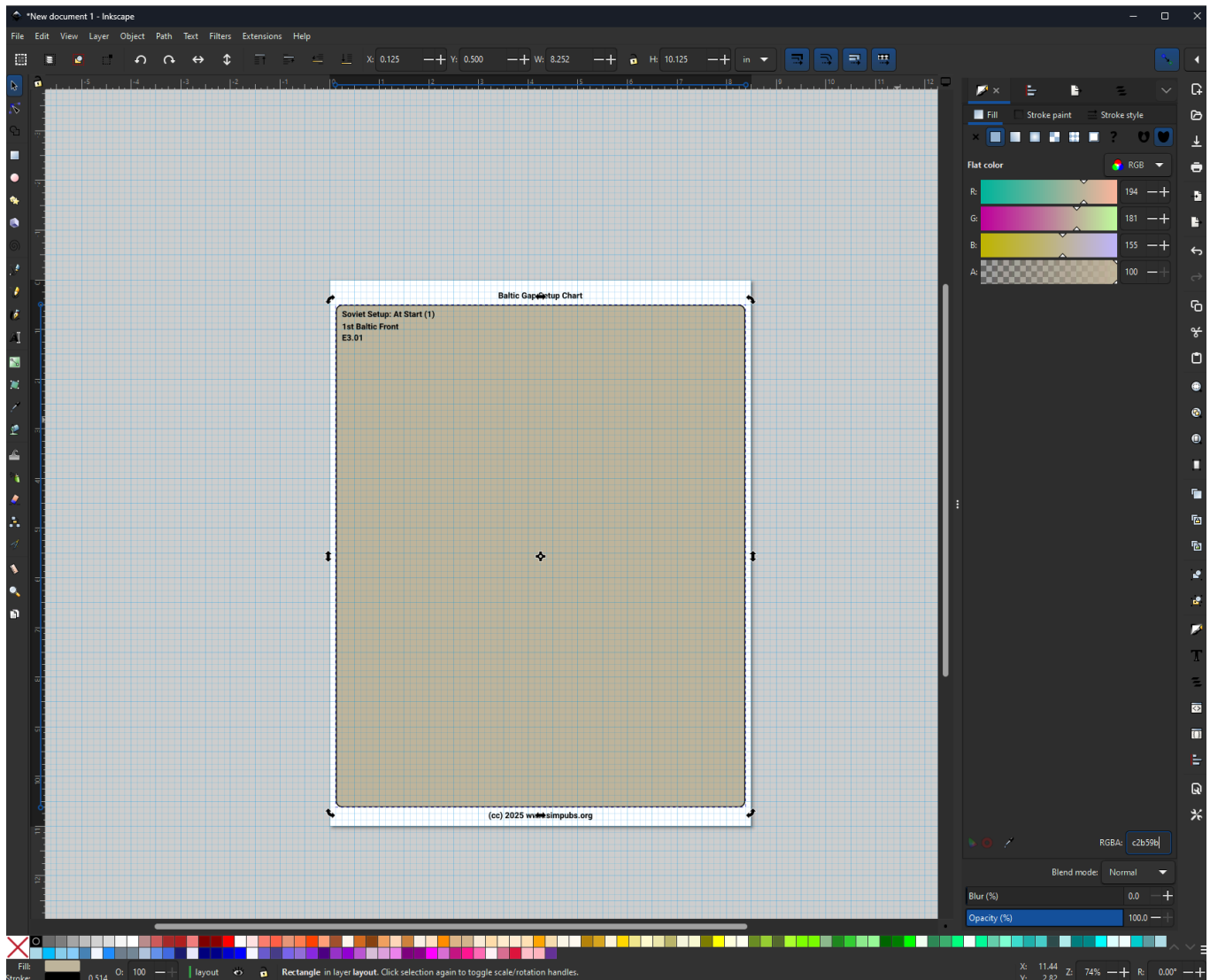
Change the layer name to something helpful like `Layout` and right click the ruler and select `in` as units.

Page Layout

The counters will go on a background, which I make with a rectangle. Selected the `Rectangle` tool and click and drag. I like a rounded corner; change `Rx` and `Ry` in the top bar, having to `0.125"`. I used a `2px` wide box



I've filled it with a Soviet brown, using the Fill on the right. This is RGB c2b59b ■ and added some text. If you need to know how to add text, refer to [Writing Text — Inkscape Beginners' Guide 1.3 documentation](#). I am not messing with fonts; I just used the standard Sans Serif



Vassal Counters

The only secret here is that I get my counters from Vassal.

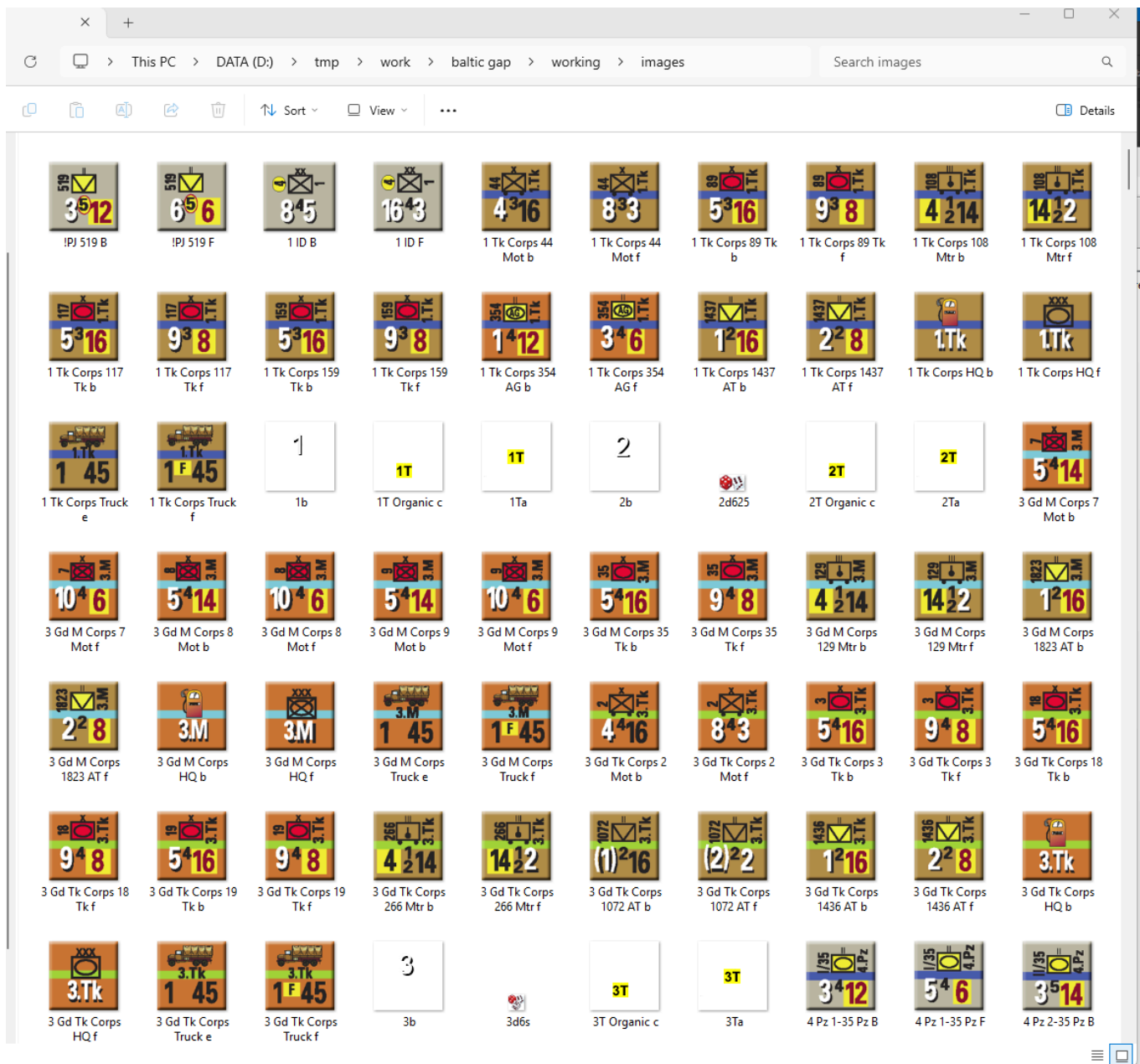
If you do not know, a vassal vmod is just a zip file. Download the mod you want (I have Baltic Gap [Module:Baltic Gap - Vassal](#)).

If you double click it, it will open Vassal. That's not what you want.

I use winzip for my zip files/vmods. You can change the vmod to zip and double click, but I prefer to right click the downloaded file, and `Open with 7Zip File Manager`

D:\tmp\work\baltic gap\BalticGap_v5_14.vmod\					
File Edit View Favorites Tools Help					
Add Extract Test Copy Move Delete Info					
D:\tmp\work\baltic gap\BalticGap_v5_14.vmod\					
Name	Size	Packed Size	Modified	Created	Accessed
images	21 992 821	21 551 394			
buildFile.xml	536 073	38 936	2024-01-20 07:34		
5.1 The Full Campaign.vsav	267 870	239 723	2024-01-19 11:55		
5.4 The Baltic Gap.vsav	263 479	233 758	2024-01-19 11:56		
5.7 September Campaign.vsav	251 295	224 336	2024-01-19 11:56		
5.5 August Campaign.vsav	238 967	212 046	2024-01-19 11:56		
5.8 Courland Pocket.vsav	216 832	190 281	2024-01-19 11:56		
Keyboard Shortcuts.pdf	185 104	176 041	2024-01-19 11:09		
5.2 Deep Battle.vsav	143 582	126 323	2024-01-19 11:55		
5.6 Doppelkopf.vsav	124 806	110 680	2024-01-19 11:56		
5.3 Attrition Battle.vsav	118 589	105 895	2024-01-19 11:55		
moduledata	305	192	2024-01-20 07:34		

You want the `images` folder, either drag it somewhere to work with, or open it and drag the contents to a working folder you create. This will now have **ALL** the images from vassal



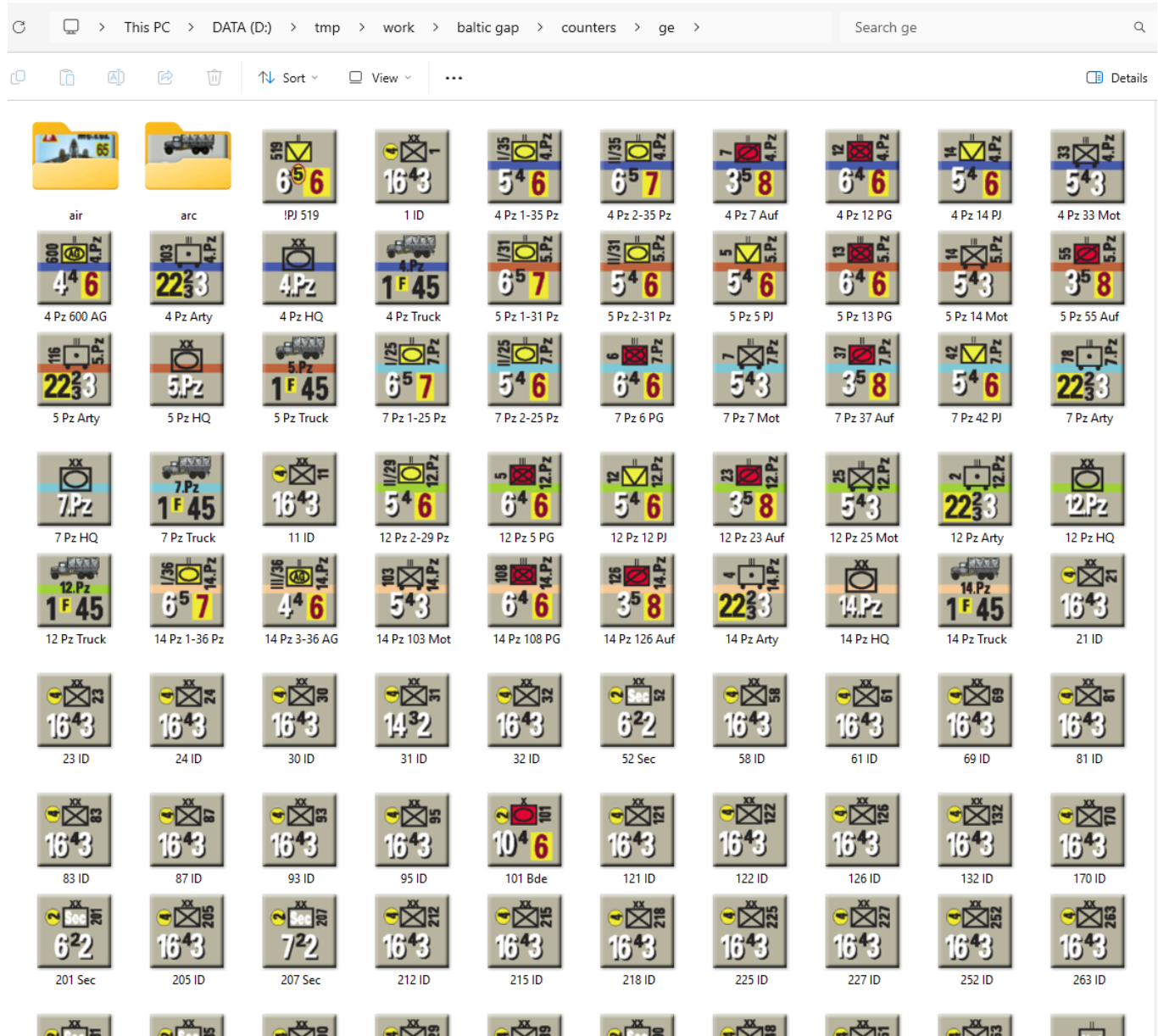
I recommend you just delete the ones that are not counters. A quick way to do this is to sort by size, using **View/Details** and delete the big stuff

x +				
> This PC > DATA (D:) > tmp > work > baltic gap > working > images Search in				
Sort ▾ View ▾ Set as background Rotate left Rotate right ...				
Name	Date	Type	Size	Tags
BG Map1	19/01/2024 10:09	PNG File	9,271 KB	
BG Axis OOA	19/01/2024 10:09	PNG File	630 KB	
BG Soviet OOA	19/01/2024 10:09	PNG File	569 KB	
v4.3 Charts (final)-2 1000	30/03/2018 16:36	PNG File	528 KB	
v4.3 Charts (final)-1 1000	30/03/2018 16:36	PNG File	484 KB	
v4.3 Charts (final)-4 1000	30/03/2018 16:36	PNG File	477 KB	
v4.3 Charts (final)-3 1000	30/03/2018 16:36	PNG File	474 KB	
BG Repl & Supply Tables	19/01/2024 10:09	PNG File	323 KB	
German Formations BG	19/01/2024 10:09	PNG File	172 KB	
Soviet Formations BG	19/01/2024 10:09	PNG File	165 KB	
BG TEC	19/01/2024 10:09	PNG File	132 KB	
BG Event Shipping Weather T...	19/01/2024 10:09	PNG File	108 KB	
Supply_Dumps_Page	19/01/2024 10:09	PNG File	107 KB	
Supply_Dumps_Page2	19/01/2024 10:09	PNG File	107 KB	
BG TRC	19/01/2024 10:09	PNG File	101 KB	
Allied Boxes small	19/01/2024 10:09	PNG File	55 KB	
German Offboard small	19/01/2024 10:09	PNG File	31 KB	
Supply Cache 2	16/10/2017 13:20	PNG File	24 KB	
Supply Cache 1	16/10/2017 13:15	PNG File	24 KB	
Allied Dead Pile	19/01/2024 10:09	PNG File	14 KB	
Trainbusting-German	19/01/2024 10:09	PNG File	14 KB	
LR Li.2 b	19/01/2024 10:09	PNG File	10 KB	
Li.2 b	19/01/2024 10:09	PNG File	10 KB	
Li.2 f	19/01/2024 10:09	PNG File	10 KB	
Pe.2 b	19/01/2024 10:09	PNG File	10 KB	
He.111 2-12 F	19/01/2024 10:09	PNG File	10 KB	
Gds Pe.2 b	19/01/2024 10:09	PNG File	10 KB	
LR Li.2 f	19/01/2024 10:09	PNG File	10 KB	
Me.262 F	19/01/2024 10:09	PNG File	10 KB	
Gds Pe.2 f	19/01/2024 10:09	PNG File	10 KB	

I then just delete the images which are not counters, and I usually create a bunch of subfolders for my factions (GE, SU, Markers) and maybe an `archive` folder and then move into the subfolders

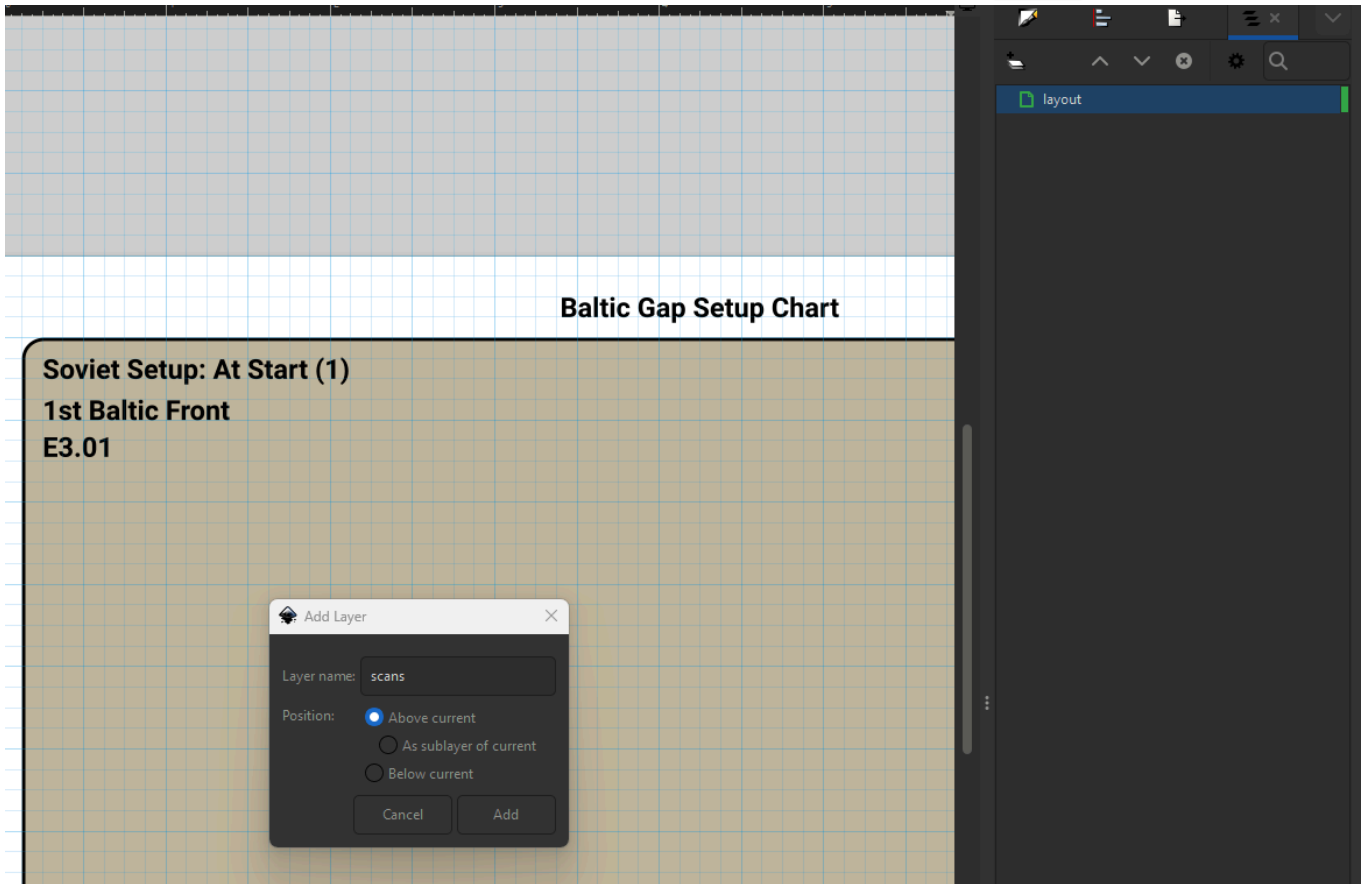
I did a search for all ending in `* b.png` and moved them to a folder `back` (you can delete them if you like, unless you are doing game setup where some units start flipped)

Here, for example, is my GE folder (where I created an `air` and `arc` archive folder also)



Adding Inkscape Counters

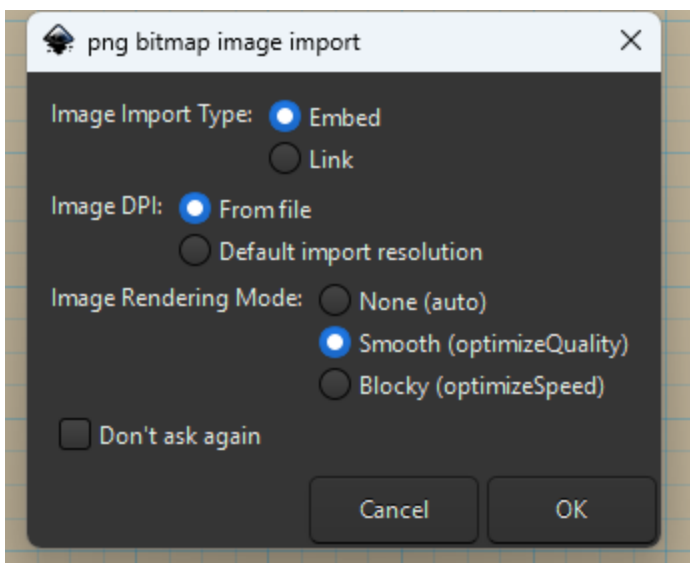
I recommend adding a layer. Right click in the Layer window and add `scans` above and



'lock' the layout layer to stop moving contents about

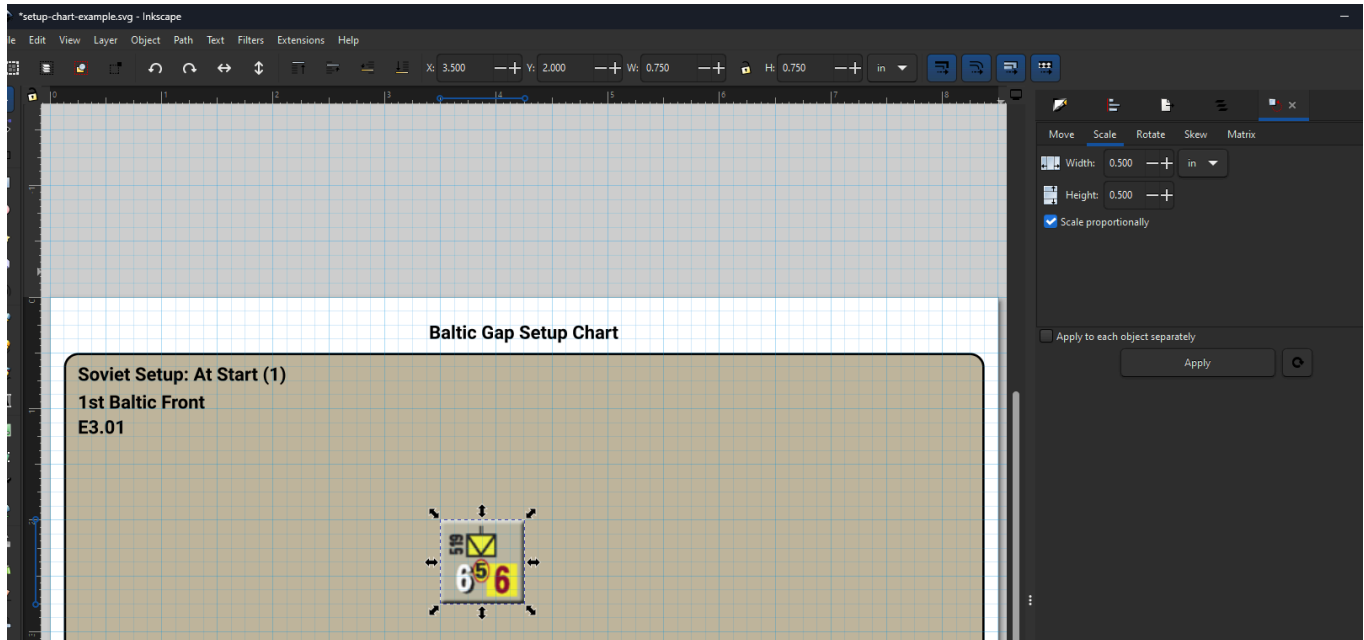


select the `scans` layer and drop a counter. You'll get this dialogue



I've selected *smooth* for fun

The counters are (mostly) 72x72 pixels (px) in Vassal. Inkscape works at 96ppi (pixels per inch) so the counter you have dropped is $72/96=0.75$ ", so it's too big.

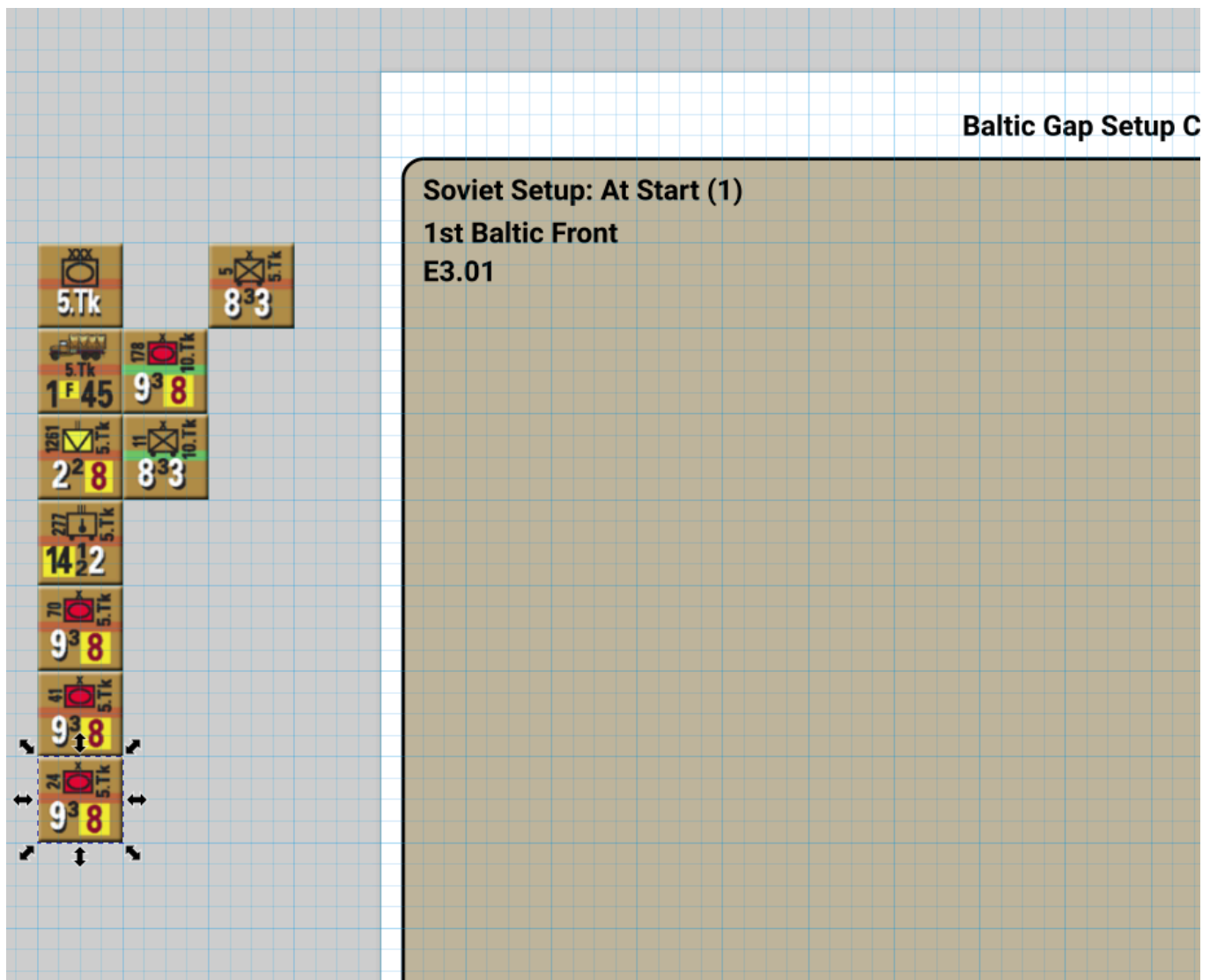


Quick fix - menu **Object/Transform** and set the width to 0.5 in and set **Scale Proportionally** and it will resize

Now, delete the counter (eek!) and select *all* the counters you want and drop. This time tick **Don't ask again** and all of the counters will be dropped.

Drag around all of them (which looks like one counter, it isn't). Resize again, and they will all be 1/2" square. Now click the top one and move it, the hard work is sorting out into types so you can find them easily.

I put them off the page canvas so I can drag them back onto the page where I need them

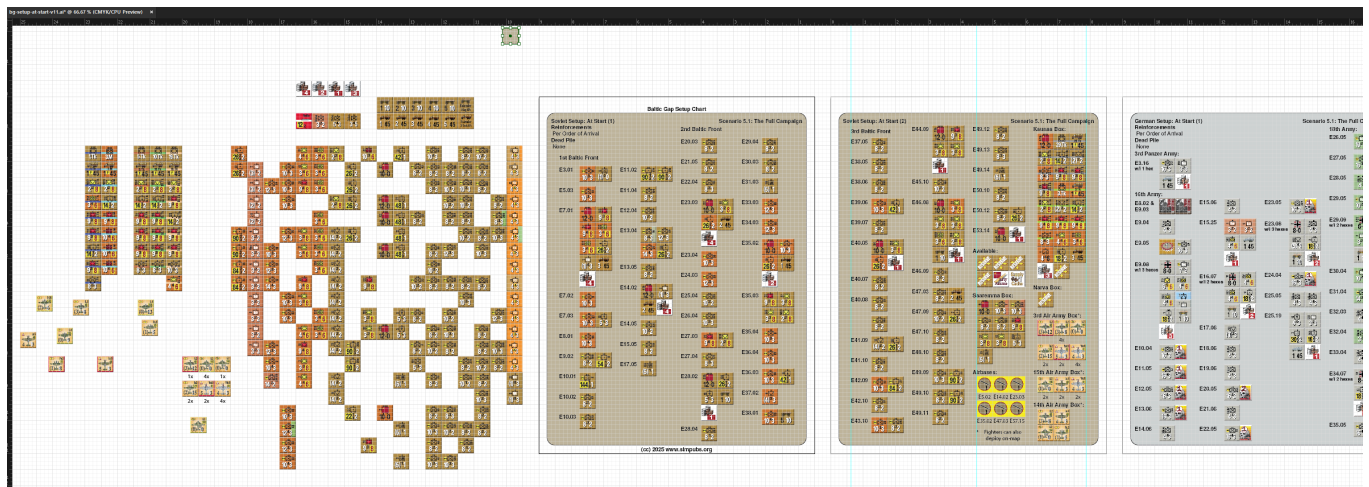


Now, add the text, guided by the Exclusive Rules pdf

http://www.ocsdepot.com/images/contentfile/Baltic_Gap_v23a_Rules_210303.pdf and shuffle in your counters to make a setup page. The grid is your friend.

You might find you want to use guides to line up. Exactly how the page works out and how many counters per hex etc will depend on the deployment.

Here is my Illustrator version in progress; different software, same principles



This is the beta/final page 1

Baltic Gap Setup Chart

Soviet Setup: At Start (1)

Reinforcements

Per Order of Arrival

Dead Pile

None

1st Baltic Front

E3.01  10³3  (1)⁰0

E5.03  10³3

E7.01  12⁰0  9³8
 9⁴8  3⁴6
 3⁴6  26³2
 (1)⁰3  3 45
 4

E7.02  10³3

E7.03  10³3  5⁵3

E8.01  10⁴3

E9.02  8²2  54¹2

E10.01  144³1

E10.02  8²2

E10.03  8²2

E11.02  90²2  90²2

E11.04  8¹2

E12.04  10²2

E13.04  8⁴3  12⁴3
 14⁴3  26¹2

E13.05  8²2

E14.02  12⁰0  (1)⁰3
 2 45  4

E14.05  10²2

E15.05  8¹2

E17.05  (5)¹1

Scenario 5.1: The Full Campaign

2nd Baltic Front

E20.03  8¹2

E21.05  8¹2

E22.04  8³3

E23.03  10⁰0  3²8
 26²2  2 45
 4

E23.04  10³3

E24.03  12³3

E25.04  10²2

E26.04  10³3

E27.03  9⁴8  2²8

E27.04  8³3

E28.02  12⁰0  26¹2
 5⁵3  1 10
 1

E28.04  8¹2

E29.04  8²2

E30.03  8¹2

E31.03  (5)¹1

E33.03  12³3

E34.03  12³3

E35.02  10⁰0  10⁴3
 26³2  1 45
 2

E35.03  9³8  3²8
 3²8  2²8

E35.04  10³3

E36.04  10³3

E36.03  10⁴3  42¹1

E37.02  (4)³3

E38.01  10³3  5 10